

# RuneScape animation project aims to bring Gielinor to the screen

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The fantasy world of RuneScape could gain a new audience through animation. Lyrical Animation is developing a series based on the game in **partnership** with its developer, Jagex, and online creator Charlie White, known as MoistCr1TiKaL.

Jagex chief executive Jon Bellamy announced the project on Saturday on stage at RuneFest in Birmingham, UK. It would bring Gielinor, the setting for RuneScape's adventures, to the screen. Bellamy described it as part of a wider ambition to expand the fictional world beyond games.

Jagex first released RuneScape in 2001. It is a **multiplayer** online role-playing game: many people play over the internet, taking on characters within a shared world. Players explore, complete quests, take part in combat and cooperate on adventures in a medieval fantasy setting.

The **franchise**, a group of related titles, now includes RuneScape, Old School RuneScape and RuneScape Dragonwilds. Bellamy said players had helped shape its characters and stories over 25 years. He hopes new projects can appeal both to people who already know Gielinor and to newcomers.

White is a longtime member of the game's **community**. He said he had played for 22 years and was excited to work on a favorite fictional property. Across his channels and platforms, he has more than 25 million followers.

Lyrical Animation will produce the project with White's Meatier Productions. Its creative director, Daniel Dominguez, highlighted RuneScape's combination of humor and **insight** as a quality he wanted to bring to life.

Work remains at an early stage, and the company expects to reveal more details in 2027.

## Word Treasure

**partnership** -- An arrangement to work together.

**multiplayer** -- Allowing several people to play together.

**franchise** -- A group of related games or other works.

**community** -- People who share an interest or activity.

**insight** -- A thoughtful understanding of something.

**development** -- The process of planning and creating a project.

## Background you need

A multiplayer online role-playing game lets people take on characters in a shared world over the internet.

The RuneScape franchise includes RuneScape, Old School RuneScape and RuneScape Dragonwilds.

## Break it down

Opens with the animation project and its development partners.

Connects the RuneFest announcement to Jagex's plans beyond games.

Explains RuneScape's history, gameplay and related titles.

Describes White's connection to the game.

Identifies the producers and Dominguez's storytelling interests.

Closes with the development status and expected 2027 details.

## Why it matters

The project shows how a game's fictional world can be adapted for another medium. Bellamy hopes it will reach both existing players and newcomers.

## Test what you remember

**1. Which company is developing the RuneScape animated series?**

- ☐ (A) Meatier Productions
- ☐ (B) RuneFest
- ☐ (C) Lyrical Animation
- ☐ (D) Jagex

**2. What wider ambition did Bellamy describe?**

- ☐ (A) Combining RuneScape's titles into one game
- ☐ (B) Adding more quests to existing games
- ☐ (C) Moving RuneScape's events to new cities
- ☐ (D) Expanding RuneScape's world beyond games

**3. When did Jagex first release RuneScape?**

- ☐ (A) In 2021
- ☐ (B) In 2011
- ☐ (C) In 2026
- ☐ (D) In 2001

**4. What does the article mean by a franchise?**

- ☐ (A) A team of online players
- ☐ (B) A group of related titles
- ☐ (C) A series of annual festivals
- ☐ (D) A collection of player accounts

**5. Which storytelling qualities did Dominguez highlight?**

- ☐ (A) Speed and competition
- ☐ (B) History and accuracy
- ☐ (C) Humor and insight
- ☐ (D) Mystery and suspense

**6. What is the project's current status?**

- ☐ (A) It has finished its first season.
- ☐ (B) It has begun its second season.
- ☐ (C) It is in early development.
- ☐ (D) It is ready for its premiere.

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: D 4: B 5: C 6: C

## Questions to think about

1. **Jon Bellamy:** He said players helped shape RuneScape's stories and described opportunities to bring its world beyond games to familiar and new audiences.
2. **Charlie White:** He said he had played RuneScape for 22 years and was excited to work on the project.
3. **Daniel Dominguez:** He highlighted RuneScape's humor and insight and expressed enthusiasm about bringing its storytelling to the screen.

**MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):**